Industry reacts to EU-China hybrid cars deal

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【要点】

・EUと中国の間でハイブリッド車輸入制限に関する暫定合意がなされ、欧州の自動車メーカー（ステランティス、ルノー、フォルクスワーゲンなど）がこれを歓迎している。

・2027年の輸入上限が35万台に設定され、欧州委員会は12月1日に施行予定で、年間6%増加する予定である。

・欧州自動車工業会（ACEA）は、中国メーカーがハイブリッド市場で急速に成長していることは無視できないが、過度な競争は避けるべきだと述べている。

・ドイツの自動車ロビーVDAは交渉を「最初の前向きな兆候」と評価し、ベルリンが過去の報復懸念から方針転換した。

・欧州の輸送労働組合はセーサー（EU航空交通管理研究パートナーシップ）の今後について不確実性が残っており、黒海安全保障に関する議論で船員の安全を含めるよう呼びかけている。

【メール原文】

Presented by BMW Group By TOMMASO LECCA with JORDYN DAHL and MARTINA SAPIO SNEAK PEEK — Europe's carmakers welcomed the tentative deal between Brussel

Presented by BMW Group

By TOMMASO LECCA

with JORDYN DAHL and MARTINA SAPIO

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SNEAK PEEK

— Europe’s carmakers welcomed the tentative deal between Brussels and Beijing as Chinese firms descended on Paris for the auto show.

— Uncertainty looms over the future of SESAR, the EU public-private research partnership to improve air traffic management and reduce delays and emissions.

— European transport unions are urging EU leaders to include seafarer safety in this week’s Black Sea security debate, as attacks on civilian shipping mount.

¡HOLA, ESPAÑA! Spain is heading to the polls on Nov. 29 — giving readers plenty of reason to keep a close eye on Madrid. The campaign will play out against big debates over the economy, migration, energy, tech and Spain’s role in Europe and the world, with consequences that will be felt across the

globe. And the timing couldn't be better: Madrid Playbook, POLITICO's first Spanish-language Playbook, launched today with the inside line on the people, politics and power shaping Spain. Read the inaugural edition here , and sign up to follow the race — and what Madrid does next.

Good morning, and welcome to Morning Mobility.

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DRIVING THE DAY

INDUSTRY REACTS TO HYBRID DEAL: The Paris Auto Show kicked off Monday, and the topic on everyone's lips was the tentative deal between Brussels and Beijing to curb the surge of imported Chinese hybrid vehicles. European automakers Stellantis, Renault and Volkswagen welcomed the deal, though they were cautious and awaiting further details. POLITICO has them.

Quotas: Multiple industry representatives confirmed to Jordyn in Paris that the imports will be capped at 350,000 in 2027. An EU diplomat told our trade colleagues that the European Commission plans on introducing the safeguard measures on Dec. 1, and the quota will increase by 6% annually. A senior automotive executive told Jordyn that the quota will be filled on a first come, first served basis.

Good news: "The speed at which Chinese manufacturers are gaining ground in Europe, particularly in the hybrid and plug-in hybrid segments, cannot be ignored. Healthy competition is welcome, but destabilisation is to be avoided," Sigrid de Vries, director general of car lobby ACEA, told POLITICO.

Piling on: German car lobby VDA, meanwhile, called the talks "a first positive sign." Berlin has historically been reticent to talk trade measures against Beijing over fears of retaliation. But the crisis engulfing its automotive sector has changed that calculus. Mercedes-Benz also tentatively welcomed the agreement in a statement to POLITICO.

Friendly fire: Unlike voluntary export restraints, safeguards are compatible with WTO rules. However, they apply to all trade partners and could also affect imports from other countries. For example, in 2024, the U.K. was the biggest exporter of plug-in hybrids to the EU, Eurostat data shows .

Cold water: The deal could still fall apart if Chinese leader Xi Jinping rejects the terms.

Luxury segment up next: Just days after the Commission announced a tentative deal with Beijing to curb the surge of hybrid imports, Chinese brands descended en masse on Paris for the auto show. Chinese state media portrayed their presence as an opportunity for Europe. "There is no need for Europe to view the entry of Chinese automakers simply as a threat to its domestic industry," Zhang Xiang, a visiting professor at the Huanghe Science and Technology University, told the Global Times . He added the two sides "can achieve mutual benefits through technological cooperation."

Good company: Some are doing just that, such as Stellantis' joint venture with Leapmotor. The Chinese brand has seen its sales surge across the EU over the past year. But Leapmotor focuses on the mass market segment, while many of its peers used the Paris Auto Show to reveal their next target: the luxury market.

Read more from Jordyn here . And catch up on the 5 takeaways from the China deal.

AVIATION

SESAR SHOWCASES RESULTS AMID BUDGET TALKS: SESAR, short for the Single European Sky Air traffic management Research joint undertaking, held its annual conference Monday as uncertainty looms over its future. The Commission is reportedly considering merging the public-private partnership — established to improve air traffic management and reduce delays and emissions — with Clean Aviation, another EU research partnership focused on developing cleaner aircraft technologies.

All about money: The potential merger is part of a broader plan to reduce the number of research partnerships under the EU's next long-term budget, but the Commission has not yet formally presented the proposal.

Harsh reality: Despite European air traffic management technology being used to manage 70 percent of the world's airspace, the EU still struggles to manage its own skies because of capacity limitations, staff shortages and fragmentation across national borders. It would be "much easier to have a single ANSP [air navigation service provider] across Europe, but this is politically not possible," said Andreas Boschen, SESAR's executive director, arguing that cooperation and technological interoperability among ANSPs are the only way forward.

Among SESAR's achievements is allowing air traffic controllers to sequence arriving aircraft much earlier in their journeys, so they can land safely, without unnecessary delays. Where it has been implemented, the system helps aircraft follow the "right trajectory, at the right speed, at the right height" from as far as 370 kilometers before landing.

Boschen also highlighted cross-border free-route airspace, enabled in part by technology developed through SESAR , which allows airlines to fly more direct routes across national borders rather than following fixed flight paths. This helps reduce flight times, fuel consumption and emissions.

Invisible help: Speaking to Tommaso about the difficulty of explaining SESAR's contribution to people unfamiliar with air traffic management, Boschen acknowledged that "the best for ATM is [when] no passenger is noticing that it exists," because flights arrive on time and safely.

What's next? One of the next challenges for air traffic management is separating IT infrastructure from the services running on it, allowing software upgrades without having to replace entire systems — much like updating a smartphone, Boschen said. "Today, in the old legacy systems, an update is a major thing, which happens every five, 10 years," he added.

A message from BMW Group: Europe has invested more than €72 billion in its battery value chain. But building competitive production capacity at scale requires the right conditions — and time. Dr. Frank Niederländer of BMW Group discusses what is needed to build a competitive battery ecosystem, going beyond targets and improving investment conditions. Read the interview here .

MARITIME

SEAFARERS WANT A PLACE IN THE EUCO DEBATE: Europe's transport unions are urging EU leaders meeting in Brussels this week to put the safety of seafarers and dock workers at the center of their response to attacks on civilian shipping in the Black Sea, as the spillover from Russia's war against Ukraine escalates, according to a letter seen in advance by Martina.

Background: The European Transport Workers' Federation argues that the debate has focused heavily on maritime security and trade while paying too little attention to the people working on ships and in

ports, and will send the appeal to EU leaders today, ahead of the Oct. 15-16 European Council summit.

Why now: The appeal follows a series of deadly incidents last week. ETF points to an Oct. 3 strike on a merchant vessel in the Odesa region that killed one seafarer and injured three others, followed by the Oct. 6 attacks on the Alfa Watan and Able in Bulgaria's exclusive economic zone. The Alfa Watan sank and its crew remains missing, while all 18 crew members from the Able were rescued, two with serious injuries.

The workers' ask: ETF wants stronger protection for merchant vessels and crews, sustained search-and-rescue efforts, better emergency planning for dock workers and safeguards for workers facing serious danger. It is also calling for unions to be involved in decisions affecting high-risk operations and for the EU and member countries to restore safe passage for merchant shipping in the Black Sea, protect civilian maritime infrastructure and investigate attacks on vessels and ports.

EUCO backdrop: This week's summit will discuss continued support for Ukraine, Russia-linked hybrid attacks and the operational needs of Ukraine's critical infrastructure ahead of winter. The ETF is arguing that civilian crews and port workers should be part of the security debate, not treated simply as collateral to wider questions of sanctions, energy and trade.

TRUCKS

STATE AID CRISIS FRAMEWORK PROLONGED, SAYS VDL: The Commission will prolong the bloc's temporary state aid measures to relieve companies hit by the energy crisis, Commission President Ursula von der Leyen told members of the European People's Party at a closed-door meeting in Italy on Monday.

Sicily announcement: "Our immediate plan is clear. We have deployed temporary state aid framework for the industrial sectors most exposed. And we will prolong and extend it," von der Leyen told the center-right party's members during their four-day study retreat in Taormina, Sicily, according to a copy of the speech seen by POLITICO.

Crisis response: The Commission in April unveiled the Middle East crisis Temporary State Aid Framework to allow EU countries more leeway in supporting sectors that are suffering from the effects of the Iran crisis. The framework covers agriculture, fisheries, land transport and intra-EU short-sea shipping. It is due to expire at the end of the year.

Tailor-made support: "We have set out options to help the households most in need, von der Leyen also said, adding that this would not be with "blanket handouts" but with "tailor-made support." She warned: "Borrowing costs of member states have risen steeply in recent months — we must take into account the limits of our fiscal capacity."

MILITARY MOBILITY

NATO MUST GET ASSETS MOVING EAST: NATO needs to modernize its infrastructure to move troops and equipment quickly from Western to Eastern Europe, Whitaker told the Warsaw Security Forum on Monday. More here .

PIT STOPS

Airport lobby ACI Europe and Airlines for Europe have called for immediate operational and regulatory changes to the EU's Entry/Exit System.

A message from BMW Group: Europe’s automotive industry is entering a crucial decade. As manufacturers navigate electrification, global competition, geopolitical uncertainty and rising energy costs, Europe faces the challenge of delivering decarbonization while strengthening competitiveness and resilience. In this Q&A , POLITICO Studio speaks to Dr. Frank Niederländer, Vice President for Government Affairs Europe at BMW Group, about the choices and conditions that will shape the next phase of Europe’s automotive transition. He discusses how Europe can strengthen the industrial base behind the transition, what it will take to build a competitive battery ecosystem and why establishing new capabilities requires the right investment conditions — and time to scale. He also explores why we should look beyond tailpipe emissions to consider the full value chain, and the potential role of renewable fuels alongside electrification. And why the transition will only succeed if it works for consumers and businesses while keeping investment, innovation and value creation in Europe.

Headlines

Here’s a recap of yesterday’s news, along with Pro articles and alerts from overnight.

Center-right revolt threatens to unravel EU’s flagship industry law
A bid to kill the Industrial Accelerator Act may fail, but mounting divisions over “Made in Europe” risk delaying the bill or draining its ambition.
By Francesca Micheletti, Max Griera, Gerardo Fortuna, Mathieu Pollet · Oct 13, 2026, 06:18 am Europe/Brussels CEST

Chinese carmakers are coming for Europe’s luxury market
At the Paris Auto Show, Chinese manufacturers show why the EU’s trade defenses won’t be enough to protect its auto industry.
By Jordyn Dahl · Oct 13, 2026, 06:00 am Europe/Brussels CEST

5 things to know about the EU-China deal
Europe finally uses its market size to squeeze concessions from Beijing, a Brussels official explains.
By Koen Verhelst · Oct 12, 2026, 06:40 pm Europe/Brussels CEST

Trump’s NATO envoy calls for moving military forces east as US reviews troops in Europe
Matthew Whitaker called for an overhaul of NATO’s bases and military infrastructure to move forces eastward as America reviews its troop presence in Europe.
By Chris Lunday · Oct 12, 2026, 12:52 pm Europe/Brussels CEST

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